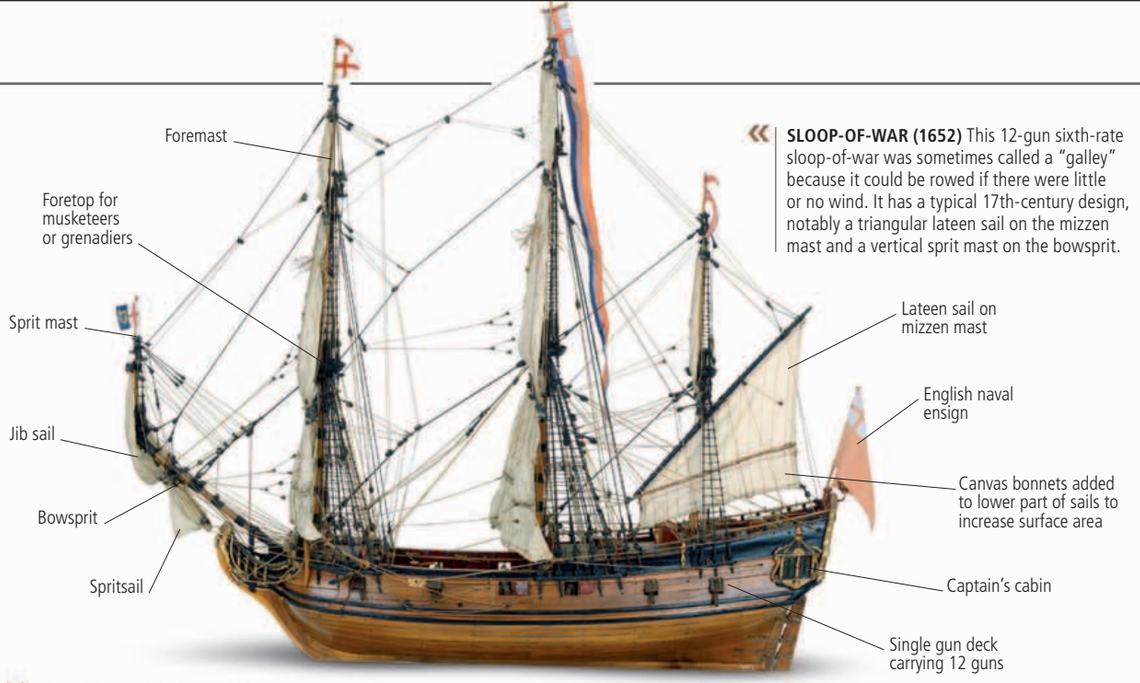
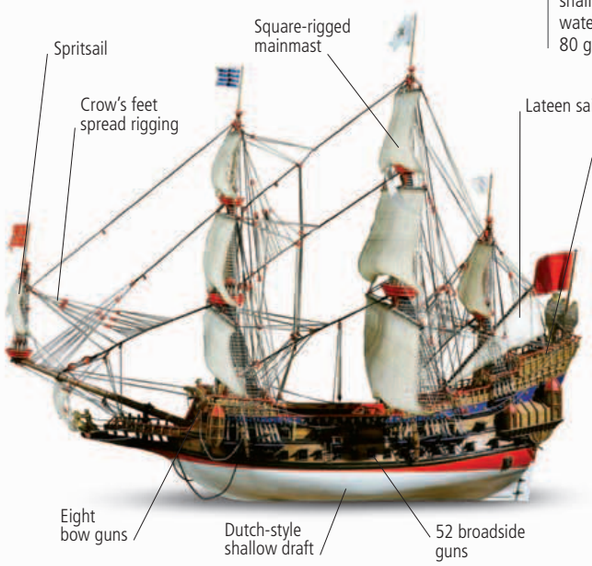
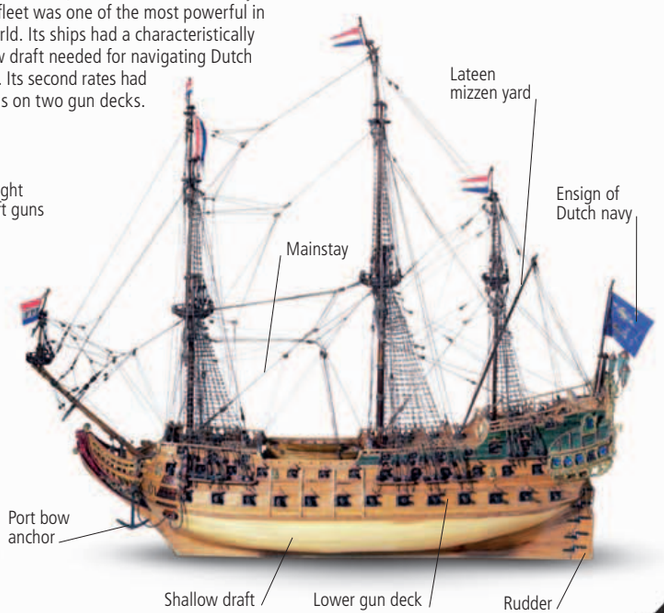


SLOOP-OF-WAR (1652) This 12-gun sixth-rate sloop-of-war was sometimes called a "galley" because it could be rowed if there were little or no wind. It has a typical 17th-century design, notably a triangular lateen sail on the mizzen mast and a vertical sprit mast on the bowsprit.

GALLEON (1636) In the 1630s Cardinal Richelieu developed France's first regular navy. *La Couronne*, based on a Dutch design, was the new navy's most prestigious ship.

SECOND RATE (1670) In the 17th century the Dutch fleet was one of the most powerful in the world. Its ships had a characteristically shallow draft needed for navigating Dutch waters. Its second rates had 80 guns on two gun decks.





GLOSSARY

COG Round-bottomed sailing ship developed in northern Europe in the Middle Ages.
CONGREVE ROCKET British self-propelled missile, developed in the early 19th century.
CORSAIR Polite word for "pirate."
CORVETTE Small, fast, lightly-armed, three-masted sailing ship, like a small frigate.
CORVUS Roman device lowered onto the deck of an enemy ship to enable soldiers to board.
COTTONCLAD Confederate ship in US Civil War, protected by cladding of cotton bales.
CRUISER Term originally used to describe ship's role—sailing independently, raiding or attacking merchant shipping. In late 19th century applied to steam warships smaller than a battleship, first the protected cruiser, which had decks armored against explosive shells, then the armored cruiser, with belt of armor around the hull. In 20th century cruisers were usually classed as light and heavy.
CULVERIN Narrow smooth-bored cannon of 16th and 17th centuries.
CUTTER Small sailing boat with a single mast. Also a kind of ship's boat carried by larger sailing vessel.
DAHLGREN GUN Reinforced muzzle-loading cannon, widely used on gunboats in US Civil War.
DEAD-RECKONING Method of calculating one's position at sea by the ship's speed, the time that has elapsed, and the direction steered.
DEPTH CHARGE Anti-submarine weapon designed to explode near target at depth determined by fuse.
DESTROYER Warship conceived at the end of the 19th century as a "torpedo-boat destroyer," then adapted to deliver torpedoes itself. In World Wars I and II destroyers were widely used as escorts for warships and merchant convoys. Today, they are armed with guided missiles to defend other ships from air, submarine, and surface attack.
DOUBLE To attack a single ship with broadsides from both sides.
DREADNOUGHT Launched in 1906, HMS *Dreadnought* gave her name to a new generation of battleships, faster, with more armor and heavier guns than any previous warships.

